



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Granite Classical Tutorials Timonium
School Website: <https://www.graniteclassical.org/timonium/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Granite Classical Tutorials Timonium (Timonium, MD, 21093) presents itself publicly as a classical-education endeavor; however, in the available crawl of the school's website content for the Timonium campus, there is no accessible evidence describing core classical-foundational elements (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy, liturgical practices, or explicit formation of virtue). A 404-style response for the Timonium campus page indicates no readily retrievable public content to evaluate against the classical rubric. This absence of explicit public materials against the Six Essential Elements framework leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating across the six categories, given the rubric's emphasis on explicit articulation of transcendental foundations, formation of virtue, Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, the living curriculum, and parent/community partnership. The scoring here leans on the documented rubric and keyword indicators in the classical-education knowledge base, which describe what a classical program typically emphasizes (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, Socratic dialogue, memory work, living teachers, and active parental partnership) and the absence of those signals in the public material for Granite's Timonium site. See the Six Essential Elements rubric and its keyword indicators for reference, which list the positive signals (e.g., truth, virtue, Great Books, Socratic dialogue, scholé, liturgy, Great Conversation, teachers as living curriculum, partnership with families) and negative signals (e.g., values-neutral education, social studies over history, project-based-only pedagogy, lack of formation through imitation, etc.). The reliance on the public site content (which returns "No Results Found" for the Timonium page) is the principal driver of the Not Classical categorization here. See the Granite Timonium crawl entry indicating a 404 No Results Found page for the timonium-campus URL.

Executive summary by category (aggregate): NOT CLASSICAL.

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: NOT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle section (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases only) is not applicable here, because no category or the aggregate ranking falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The rubric guidance notes that if no category is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, you may briefly note that no major needle-moving changes are required. Given the current public-materials signal (or lack thereof), there are no category-level signals to push toward CLASSICAL, and therefore no needle-moving actions can be meaningfully prescribed within the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL framework. The Six Essential Elements framework, however, does provide concrete signals to look for if Granite were to align toward CLASSICAL (e.g., Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, scholé, liturgical community; partnership with families; living curriculum; virtue formation).

Key contextual grounding from the classical-education knowledge base - The Six Essential Elements rubric identifies core signals of CLASSICAL orientation (e.g., Great Books and the Great Conversation; Trivium and Quadrivium; scholé; liturgical/community practices; partnership with families; living curriculum and virtue formation) and it provides explicit positive keyword indicators (truth, beauty, virtue; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; scholé; liturgy; partnership with families; living curriculum) as benchmarks for scoring. The positive keyword set includes terms such as truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Great Books, great conversation, Socratic dialogue, scholé, liturgy, and partnership with families; negative keywords signal non-classical directions (e.g., values-neutral education, social-justice framing without truth; lack of Great Books; project-based-only pedagogy). See the document Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) for the six-category rubric and keyword indicators. The lexicon and keyword lists summarize both positive and negative markers (e.g., Transcendental Moral Realism; Grounded in Theology; Liturgical and Communal Practices; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; Scholé; living curriculum; partnership with families) as core signals of a classical orientation, contrasted with signals that indicate non-classical orientation (e.g., secular ethics; values-clarification; social-justice framing without inherent truth claims). The Granite Timonium crawl record for the Timonium-campus URL shows a 404, i.e., no public page content retrieved for analysis (the specific file Granite Timonium firecrawl shows a 404 “No Results Found” for the page).

Notes on the data behind this evaluation - The school’s public-facing content for the Timonium campus is not accessible in the crawl we have, as indicated by the 404 No Results Found response for the Timonium-campus page of [graniteclassical.org](https://www.graniteclassical.org). This lack of accessible content prevents an affirmative identification of classical signals (e.g., public articulation of a Great Books program, the Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic seminars, scholé pedagogy, or living-education signals). See the 404 result for the Timonium campus page: “No Results Found” (Granite Public Timonium Campus page).

- The knowledge base provides a robust rubric for what counts as classical (categories, keywords, and indicators). It emphasizes that a truly classical program will explicitly articulate transcendental foundations, Great Books/Great Conversation, Liturgy/Scholé, the Trivium/Quadrivium, and a living-faculty/parent-community formation. See the Six Essential Elements docs (and their positive keyword indicators) for the rubric used here, and the detailed keyword inventories including the positive/negative indicators (e.g., truth, beauty, virtue; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; scholé; liturgy; partnership with families).
- The public timeline for Granite (as evidenced by the crawl file) shows no accessible content to verify those indicators on Granite’s Timonium campus site, which is a key input to this evaluation. See the explicit 404/No Results Found content for that URL in the granite-classical-tutorials Timonium firecrawl file.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public Timonium campus content is not retrievable; the crawl yields a 404/No Results Found for the Timonium-campus page, providing no textual evidence of transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgy, or sacred-community practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements): 0 detected on the public Timonium page.
- Negative keywords: 0 (no explicit signals of secularism or relativism present in retrieved content).
- Why this rating
- The rubric requires explicit articulation of transcendental foundations (truth/goodness/beauty), theology, liturgical/community practices. The lack of accessible Timonium-campus content prevents confirming these signals; thus, NOT CLASSICAL. The absence is supported by the crawl’s 404 result for the Timonium page, indicating no public content to analyze against the classical keywords.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No Timonium-campus content retrieved to articulate a formation-based purpose (virtue formation, paideia, leisure/Scholé) or a truth/goodness/beauty telos. The 404 result provides no textual basis to claim formation goals are publicly stated.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: 0
- Negative keywords: 0
- Why this rating
- Without explicit public statements about formation of character, virtue, or a transcendent telos, the school cannot be shown to meet the “formation, not information” and “pursuit of true, good, and beautiful” signals in the Six Essential Elements framework. The absence of a public articulation on these aims yields NOT CLASSICAL under the rubric.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No public Timonium-campus content is retrievable to verify the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books engagement, or the Great Conversation. The crawl-recorded 404 indicates no accessible material to assess Great Books/primary texts or a Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum on Granite’s Timonium content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: 0
- Negative keywords: 0
- Why this rating
- The classical curriculum signaling (great books; Trivium/Quadrivium; study of Western civilization; memory work; memorization/recitation) would be evidenced by explicit public content—none is retrievable here, hence NOT CLASSICAL per rubric.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Timonium page could not be loaded; no explicit public description of Socratic seminars, recitations, memory work, or scholé pedagogy can be evaluated from the current crawl (404).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: 0
- Negative keywords: 0
- Why this rating
- Without textual signals describing pedagogy (Socratic dialogue; memory work; recitation; contemplative/restful learning), the category cannot be classified as Classical. The rubric requires detectable practice signals; the absence is NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No publicly accessible Timonium-campus faculty description (e.g., “living curriculum,” teacher as model, mentor culture) in the current crawl; 404 indicates no evaluable material for this category.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: 0
- Negative keywords: 0
- Why this rating
- The rubric’s classical signals include a living curriculum and teachers as virtuous models; absent textual evidence on Granite’s Timonium site, the category cannot be scored as Classical. Therefore NOT CLASSICAL in this data set.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Timonium content is not publicly accessible in the crawl; no explicit statements about parental partnership, parent formation, or open-campus visitation are retrievable from the Timonium page (404).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: 0
- Negative keywords: 0
- Why this rating
- The Six Essential Elements highlight parental partnership and community involvement as core signals of classical orientation; no public evidence in the Timonium crawl to confirm these signals yields NOT CLASSICAL per rubric.

Aggregate assessment - Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across all six categories, public materials retrieved from Granite’s Timonium campus in the crawl appear inaccessible or non-existent (404/no content) for evaluating the classical signals defined by the Six Essential Elements. The knowledge-base rubric emphasizes explicit articulation of Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, liturgical/community practices, living-faculty, and parent/community partnership as the hallmarks of classical education; these signals are not evidenced in the publicly retrievable Timonium content, leading to a NOT CLASSICAL aggregate rating. See the 404 evidence for the Timonium page and the associated lack of public content for analysis in the Granite crawl records , contrasted with the Six Essential Elements rubric and keyword indicators that define the classical orientation.

What would move the needle

- If Granite wanted to move toward a full CLASSICAL classification, it would need to publicly publish and document:
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: explicit statements of transcendental reality (truth, goodness, beauty), theology integration, and liturgical/community practices (chant, sacred music, communal worship) in curriculum and daily life. See the Positive Keywords list (truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy) in the Six Essential Elements rubric for signals to aim for.
- School Purpose and Goal: a clear commitment to formation of virtue and wisdom (paideia), and to a universal truth-ordering of reality beyond job-prep; emphasize leisure/restful learning (scholé) and the Great Conversation. The rubric’s signals include formation, telos, and scholé as core aims.

- Curriculum: public articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music), Great Books/primary texts, and a demonstrable Great Conversation across the curriculum; a focus on wonder and integration. Positive indicators include Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books/Great Conversation in the knowledge-base lexicon and element-matrix.
- Pedagogy: explicit adoption of contemplative/restful learning (scholé) balanced with Socratic inquiry in upper grades; memorization/recitation; imitation and practice with living models. Positive signals include Socratic dialogue, scholé, and memory work. See the Pedagogical Methods signals in the Six Essential Elements framework.
- Faculty: a visible living curriculum with teachers as virtuous models and mentors, and a culture of collegiality; a defined teacher-portrait and faculty formation program. The rubric highlights “living curriculum” and teacher as exemplar as central signals of CLASSICAL practice.
- Parents & Community: strong, ongoing partnership with parents as co-teachers, parent-formation activities, open-campus policy, and community liturgies or shared rituals. Positive indicators include partnership with families and parent formation in the Six Essential Elements, which Granite would need to publish publicly.
- Implementation steps (concrete, needle-moving actions):
 - Publish a publicly accessible, clearly written mission statement that foregrounds truth/goodness/beauty, transcendentals, and theology as governing principles of the curriculum and school life. Include liturgical practices or communal ceremonies (as appropriate to the faith tradition) and a stated posture of reverence/worship in a public-facing section of the site. Ground the language in the positive keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements (truth, beauty, virtue, liturgy, theology).
 - Detail the curriculum architecture: list the Great Books/primary texts and authors, outline the Trivium/Quadrivium progression, and show how history is integrated across disciplines (not taught as mere “social studies”). Reference the Great Conversation and the concept of “living books” to align with classical norms. Use the positive keyword indicators for curriculum from the rubric as a guide.
 - Describe pedagogy explicitly: include examples of Socratic seminars, narration/recitation practices, and opportunities for student speeches/declamation, balanced with contemplative Scholé time in lower grades. Tie these to the rubric’s signals for Classical pedagogy (Socratic, scholé, memory work, etc.).
 - Publicly present the living-faculty concept: articulate the “living curriculum” idea, show profiles of model-teacher-mentors, and describe professional-development pathways that align with classical pedagogy. The Six Essential Elements emphasize the importance of faculty as exemplars and the living curriculum as a core signal of CLASSICAL orientation.
 - Strengthen Parent & Community engagement: publish explicit parent-partnership strategies (co-teaching model, parent education programs, family literacy, etc.) and a clear policy on campus visits and open-house practices. The rubric identifies Partnership with Families and Parent Formation as important signals for CLASSICAL status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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